At this point, you should be able to install the rbenv version manager using the instructions in Installing Ruby with the rbenv Version Manager, on page 4. The GoRails site listed above has slightly different rbenv instructions, they should both work.

Using WSL and Ruby

You should be good to go, as you can hopefully confirm by opening up a new WSL terminal and typing `irb`. Within WSL, you can use any of the Unix tools that we've described elsewhere in this book.

Ruby programs can be invoked using `ruby` from the WSL command line just as we discuss in Chapter 14, Ruby from the Command Line, on page 231. Where it gets a little bit tricky is sharing files. WSL sets up what is, in effect, its own file system. For performance reasons, you are encouraged to keep all the files you use in WSL code in the WSL file system (as apparently file read and write between the two systems is expensive).

That said, it is possible to share. Windows files are set up in WSL under the `mnt` directory (short for "mount point"). So, your `C:` drive is `/mnt/c`. You can access Windows files using that path as a prefix. Other drives, like network drives, can also be connected to a mount point, but it doesn't happen by default.

From the Windows side, WSL files show up in the File Explorer under their own "Linux" heading. You can right-click on those files, and open them in a Windows editor, but you can't directly invoke them in WSL from the Windows file system. (You could, in theory, create a shortcut that invokes a terminal and a single bash command to run a WSL file.)

Visual Studio Code has a WSL extension that you can install that allows you to load a WSL directory from regular Windows version of Visual Studio Code, run that directory using the WSL ruby, and use the WSL terminal as a prompt. Similarly, RubyMine allows you to connect to WSL as a remote interpreter and open a WSL project and run it using the WSL Ruby.

Using RubyInstaller

Although WSL is nice, and it's great to be able to seamlessly integrate with existing Ruby tooling, from the point of view of a Windows user, it does have some drawbacks. WSL has some performance overhead, including taking up a lot of memory. It also doesn't integrate with the Windows system directly, meaning that you can't do Windows-specific things.

There is a native Ruby installation for Windows, simply called RubyInstaller.[13] RubyInstaller is a regular Windows installer that gives you a regular Windows executable Ruby interpreter that you can use to run Ruby code.

Installing Ruby With RubyInstaller

RubyInstaller can be downloaded from https://rubyinstaller.org, where there are versions corresponding to each Ruby patch version for both x64 machines and x86 machines. There are versions both with and without Devkit, which is an add-on that allows Ruby gems that have native C-language extensions to be compiled. There are a couple of prominent Ruby gems that have extensions, so we recommend the Devkit version.

Once the installer has downloaded, run it and you'll get a standard Windows installer. You will have options to "Add Ruby executables to your PATH" and "Associate .rb and .rbw

13. https://rubyinstaller.org